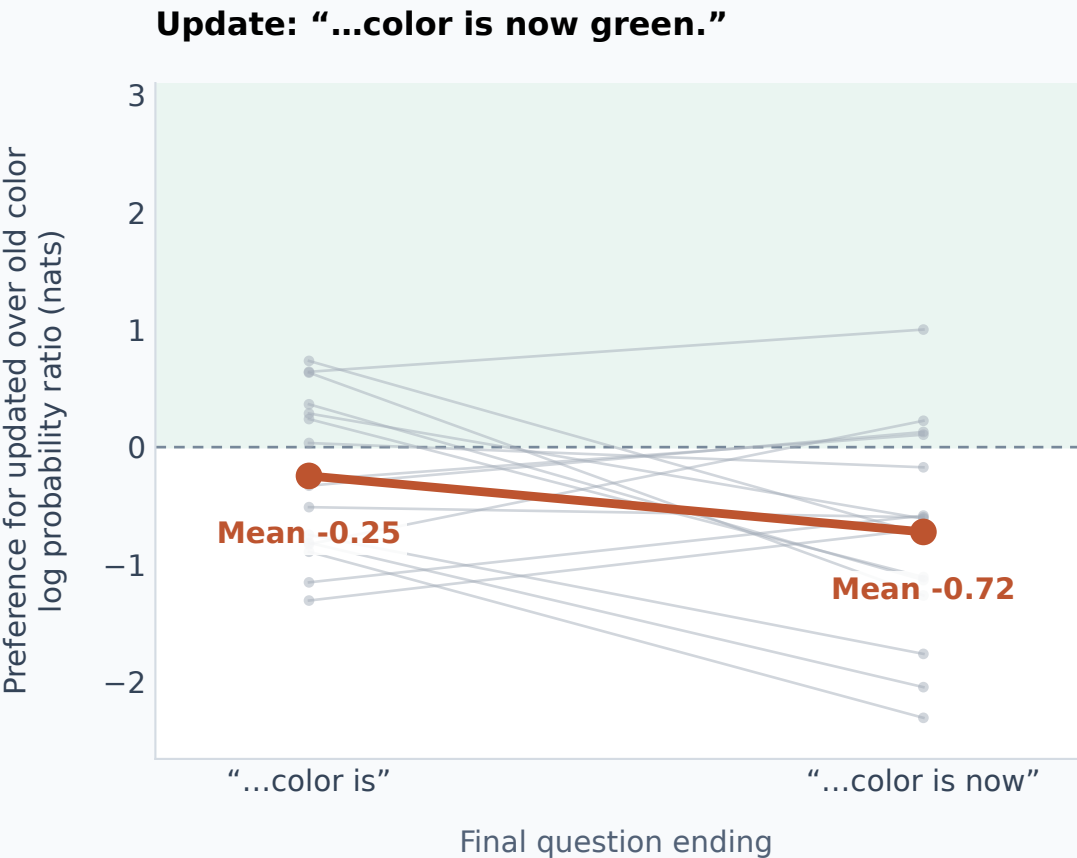


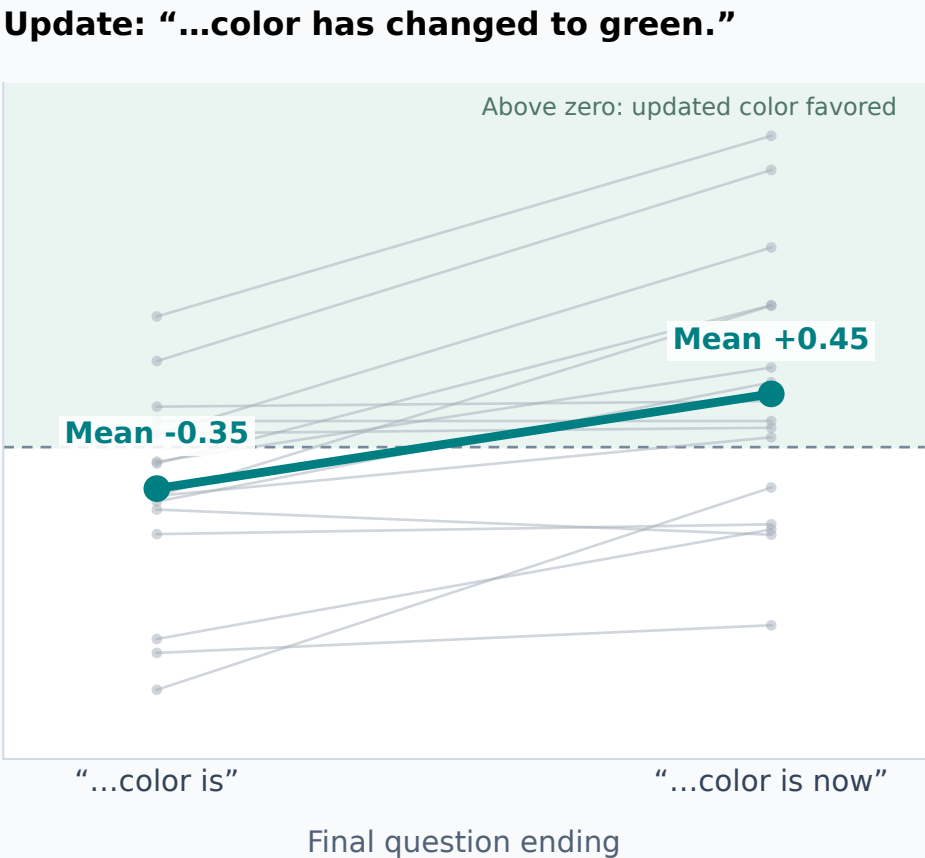
“Now” can favor the old answer

Qwen3-0.6B · 64 counterbalanced discovery prompts

Both prompts state an updated color. Adding “now” to the final question has opposite average effects depending on how the update was phrased.



Updated color beats old color: 7/16 → 4/16



Updated color beats old color: 6/16 → 11/16

Thin lines: 16 matched prompt pairs per panel. Thick line: mean. Each pair differs only by the final “now”.

Native behavior only. No internal mechanism or held-out prediction has been established.

Counts compare the two color tokens; they are not full-vocabulary accuracy. No statistical error bars are claimed.